Day 3 - Tap into the local, county, state, and federal programs.

Brought to you by CURB N TURF

“Give a man a fish and you feed him for a day. Teach him how to fish and you feed him for a lifetime.”
-Lao Tzu, Chinese philosopher, founder of Taoism.

There are many feelings and strong emotions about government aid. Whether you are a fan of government aid or anti-government, it still might be a good idea to understand the vast array of resources available to help transform your property into an agritourism destination.

Federal Programs include:

- **NIFA (National Institute for Food and Agriculture)** https://www.nifa.usda.gov
  The National Institute of Food and Agriculture (NIFA) provides leadership and funding for programs that advance agriculture-related sciences. They invest in and support initiatives that ensure the long-term viability of agriculture. NIFA applies an integrated approach to ensure that groundbreaking discoveries in agriculture-related sciences and technologies reach the people who can put them into practice.
- **SARE (Sustainable Agriculture Research and Education)** www.sare.org
  The Sustainable Agriculture Research and Education (SARE) program is a decentralized competitive grants and education program operating in every state and island protectorate. SARE is divided into four different regions that operate as separate entities and run grant programs for their states.
- **AFRI (Agriculture and Food Research Initiative)** https://www.nifa.usda.gov/grants/programs/agriculture-food-research-initiative-afri
  The National Institute of Food and Agriculture (NIFA) awards AFRI research, education, and extension grants to improve rural economies, increase food production, stimulate the bioeconomy, mitigate impacts of climate variability, address water availability issues, ensure food safety and security, enhance human nutrition, and train the next generation of the agricultural workforce.
- **NRCS (Natural Resources Conservation Services)** https://www.nrcs.usda.gov/wps/portal/nrcs/site/national/home/
  Natural Resources Conservation Service, formerly known as the Soil Conservation Service, is an agency of the United States Department of Agriculture that provides technical assistance to farmers and other private landowners and managers. (wikipedia) For example, one member of the CurbNTurf team applied for a “HighTunnel Initiative” grant through the NCRS, and that paid for him to buy a large greenhouse to add to his property.
- **NET (National Extension Tourism)** https://extensiontourism.net/
  Resources including training, research, networking

State Resources.

Each state has very specific laws and regulations, resources and grants to help turn your property into an agritourism destination. Search under the state’s site for topics like agriculture, agritourism, tourism, etc. to find the wealth of resources for your state. Some states like Vermont and Tennessee are very active in helping their residents transform farms into better agricultural revenue generators.

County Resources.

Many state universities have extension programs like SDSU to help farmers and residents have access to the latest research and information in agriculture. Many of these extensions have a wealth of resources to help you learn and implement any changes to your property to help make more money. A google search for your state's extensions or for any university extensions on the particular topic you are interested in learning more about will give you a lot of information to help you get further in the development of your agritourism plan.

It's really important to also pay attention to the laws, regulations and restrictions that apply to whatever you are hoping to do. The resources we've talked about will also have links to the laws, regulations and restrictions you may encounter. It is important to involve professionals like attorneys, accountants or other professionals to ensure you are following the laws and regulations for your particular business.

It's very important to have the correct insurance coverage as well. Your local insurance provider may be able to help you to ensure you are properly insured for whatever agritourism events you are wanting to implement.

Today's Action

Create a written plan of action today of how you are going to research local, state and county programs to help improve and grow your agritourism business.

Do any of these programs spark your interest? _____

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What do you need the most help with as you improve your business? _____

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Which of these programs might be able to help you achieve your goals? _____

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What programs best fit your needs? _____

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1. Research your federal, state, county and local resources on the websites mentioned above and through Google.
2. Call organizations such as government offices, local chambers of commerce, and industry associations who might be aware of additional resources available to you.
3. Write down what you learn that applies directly to your business and make a plan to implement those resources.
4. Contact your accountant and ask about tax deductions and other opportunities that might apply to you. Your tax accountant may also be aware of other government grant opportunities.

5. Contact your attorney to ensure you are operating your business legally and that you are protecting your business legally as well as you are able. For example, are you providing services for which you should have your customers sign a waiver? Are there any notices you need to post on your property?
6. Contact your insurance provider to check your coverage is adequate for whatever products and services you are operating.

Tomorrow: Day 4

Tomorrow's lesson will teach how you can leverage the power of upselling and cross-selling to make more money from your agritourism business.

This course is brought to you by CurbNTurf, a service kind of like AirBNB, but we connect agritourism businesses and other property owners with RVers who need a place to stay while they're traveling. CurbNTurf can help bring more customers to your agritourism business, plus help you generate new income streams as the RVers pay to stay on your property. To learn more about listing your property for free on CurbNTurf, please visit: https://www.curbnturf.com/host. Or you can call us at (800) 877-5005 with an questions. We can also help you get the CurbNTurf listing for your property set up.

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